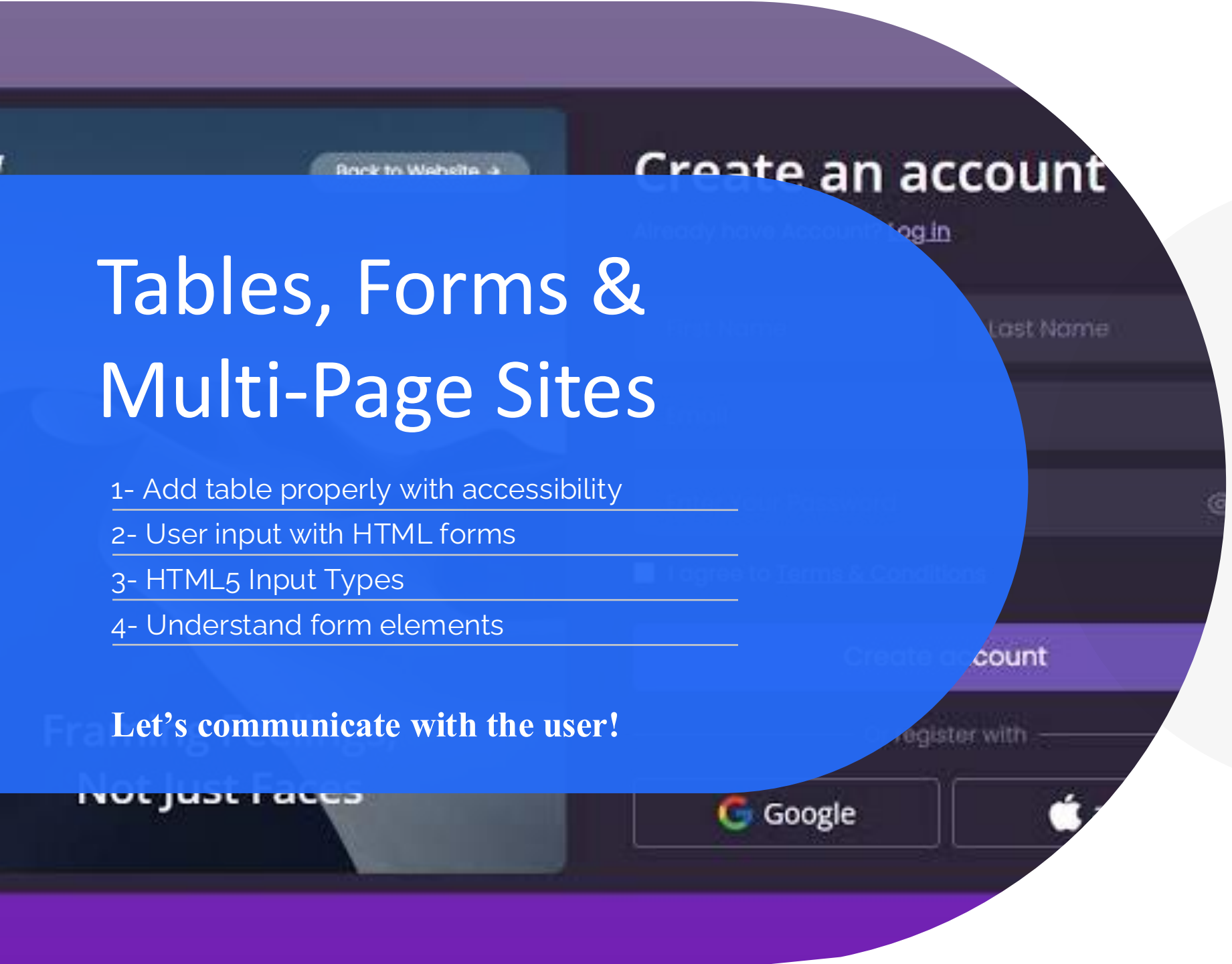
Tables, Forms & Multi-Page Sites

1- Add table properly with accessibility
2- User input with HTML forms
3- HTML5 Input Types
4- Understand form elements

Let’s communicate with the user!



SCROLL

HTML Tables

Tables = Tabular Data ONLY

Good uses:

- Sports scores
- Schedules
- Pricing charts
- Data comparison

Bad use:

- Page layout (that's CSS's job!)

Tables were abused for layout in the 1990s. Never do that. Tables are for data.

Date	Order ID	Name	Price	Quantity	Total
2017-09-29 01:22	200398	iPhone X 64Gb Grey	$999.00	1	$999.00
2017-09-28 05:57	200397	Samsung S8 Black	$756.00	1	$756.00
2017-09-26 05:57	200396	Game Console Controller	$22.00	2	$44.00
2017-09-25 23:06	200392	USB 3.0 Cable	$10.00	3	$30.00
2017-09-24 05:57	200391	Smartwatch 4.0 LTE Wifi	$199.00	6	$1494.00
2017-09-23 05:57	200390	Camera C430W 4k	$699.00	1	$699.00
2017-09-22 05:57	200389	Macbook Pro Retina 2017	$2199.00	1	$2199.00
2017-09-21 05:57	200388	Game Console Controller	$999.00	1	$999.00
2017-09-19 05:57	200387	iPhone X 64Gb Grey	$999.00	1	$999.00
2017-09-18 05:57	200386	iPhone X 64Gb Grey	$999.00	1	$999.00
2017-09-22 05:57	200389	Macbook Pro Retina 2017	$2199.00	1	$2199.00
2017-09-21 05:57	200388	Game Console Controller	$999.00	1	$999.00
2017-09-19 05:57	200387	iPhone X 64Gb Grey	$999.00	1	$999.00
2017-09-18 05:57	200386	iPhone X 64Gb Grey	$999.00	1	$999.00

Table Structure

```html
<table>
    <caption>Class Roster - Spring 2026</caption> <!-- Table title -->
    <thead> <!-- Header section -->
        <tr> <!-- Table Row -->
            <th scope="col">Name</th> <!-- Column header -->
            <th scope="col">Age</th>
            <th scope="col">Major</th>
        </tr>
    </thead>
    <tbody> <!-- Body section -->
        <tr> <!-- First student -->
            <td>Alice</td>
            <td>20</td>
            <td>Journalism</td>
        </tr>
        <tr> <!-- Second student -->
            <td>Bob</td>
            <td>22</td>
            <td>Design</td>
        </tr>
    </tbody>
</table>
```

Accessibility Checklist:

- `<caption>` describes table
- `scope="col"` on headers
- Semantic structure (thead/tbody)

HTML Forms Introduction

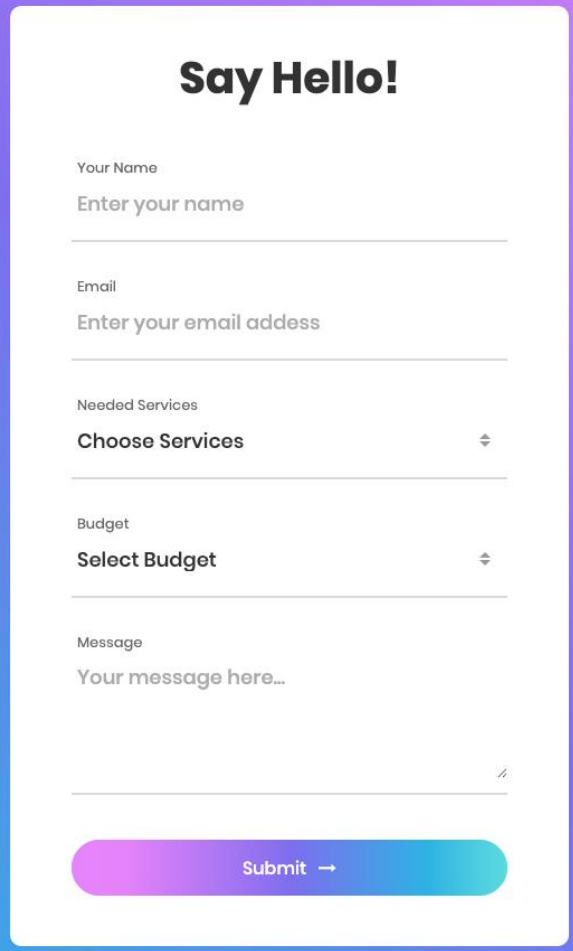
Forms = User Input

Forms let users give you information:

- Contact forms
- Login pages
- Surveys
- Search boxes
- Checkout forms

Everywhere on the web!

Forms are how websites collect data.
They're essential but complex.



Basic Form Structure

```
<form action="/submit" method="POST">
    <label for="name">Name:</label>
    <input type="text"
        id="name"
        name="name"
        required>

    <label for="email">Email:</label>
    <input type="email"
        id="email"
        name="email"
        required>

    <label for="message">Message:</label>
    <textarea id="message"
            name="message"
            rows="4"></textarea>

    <button type="submit">Send</button>
</form>
```

What Each Tag Does?

- `<form>` = Container that holds all form elements
- `<label>` = Text description that tells users what to enter
- `<input>` = Single-line field where users type
- `<textarea>` = Multi-line field for longer text
- `<button>` = Button to submit the form

Critical Attributes:

- `for` and `id` MUST match (connects label to input)
- `name` = How data is sent to server
- `required` = Field must be filled

We'll explain each element in detail next!

Form Attributes Explained

Essential Form Attributes

```
<form action="/submit" method="POST">
    <!-- form content -->
</form>
```

Form attributes:

- `action` = Where to send data (URL or service)
- `method` = How to send it (`GET` or `POST`)

Input attributes:

- `id` = Unique identifier (connects to label)
- `name` = Field name (sent to server)
- `required` = Field must be filled
- `placeholder` = Hint text (NOT a replacement for label!)



Always connect labels to inputs!

HTML5 Input Types

Text Inputs

- `type="text"` = Plain text
- `type="email"` = Email (validates format!)
- `type="tel"` = Phone number
- `type="url"` = Website address
- `type="search"` = Search box
- `type="password"` = Hidden text

Numbers & Dates

- `type="number"` = Numbers only
- `type="date"` = Date picker
- `type="time"` = Time picker
- `type="range"` = Slider

Selection

- `type="checkbox"` = Multiple choices
- `type="radio"` = Single choice
- `type="file"` = File upload

Browser automatically validates these!

```
<input type="email"
       id="email"
       name="email"
       required
       placeholder="you@example.com"
       autocomplete="email">

<input type="password"
       id="password"
       name="password"
       required
       minlength="8"
       pattern="[A-Za-z0-9]+">

<input type="number"
       id="age"
       name="age"
       min="13"
       max="120"
       step="1">
```

Form Validation & Attributes

Validation Attributes:

- `required` = Must be filled
- `minlength` / `maxlength` = Text length limits
- `min` / `max` = Number range
- `pattern` = Custom validation (advanced)
- `autocomplete` = Helps browsers auto-fill

These attributes make forms more user-friendly AND accessible

```html
<form>
    <fieldset>
        <legend>Personal Information</legend>

        <label for="fname">First Name:</label>
        <input type="text" id="fname" name="fname">

        <label for="lname">Last Name:</label>
        <input type="text" id="lname" name="lname">
    </fieldset>

    <fieldset>
        <legend>Contact Preferences</legend>

        <input type="checkbox" id="email-opt" name="email-opt">
        <label for="email-opt">Email updates</label>

        <input type="checkbox" id="sms-opt" name="sms-opt">
        <label for="sms-opt">SMS updates</label>
    </fieldset>
</form>
```

Grouping Form Elements

Why use filedset?

- Groups related fields
- `<legend>` describes the group
- Screen readers announce the group
- Helps organize complex forms

<fieldset> and <legend> are semantic HTML elements that group related form fields

Form Radio Buttons

```html
<fieldset>
    <legend>Choose your class year:</legend>

    <input type="radio" id="freshman" name="year" value="1">
    <label for="freshman">Freshman</label>

    <input type="radio" id="sophomore" name="year" value="2">
    <label for="sophomore">Sophomore</label>

    <input type="radio" id="junior" name="year" value="3">
    <label for="junior">Junior</label>

    <input type="radio" id="senior" name="year" value="4">
    <label for="senior">Senior</label>
</fieldset>
```

Radio Buttons = Choose ONE Option

How Radio Buttons Work:

- Only ONE can be selected at a time
- All options must have the SAME `name` attribute (`name="year"`)
- Each needs a unique `id` for its label
- `value` = what gets sent to the server
- Always wrap in `<fieldset>` with `<legend>`

Notice: Label comes AFTER the input (different from text fields!)

Form Checkboxes

```html
<fieldset>
    <legend>Select your interests:</legend>

    <input type="checkbox" id="sports" name="interests" value="sports">
    <label for="sports">Sports</label>

    <input type="checkbox" id="music" name="interests" value="music">
    <label for="music">Music</label>

    <input type="checkbox" id="reading" name="interests" value="reading">
    <label for="reading">Reading</label>

    <input type="checkbox" id="gaming" name="interests" value="gaming">
    <label for="gaming">Gaming</label>
</fieldset>
```

Checkboxes = Choose MULTIPLE Options

How Radio Buttons Work:

- Users can select MULTIPLE options (or none!)
- Can use the same `name` (to group) or different names
- Each needs a unique `id` for its label
- `value` = what gets sent for checked items
- Always wrap in `<fieldset>` with `<legend>`

Notice: Label also comes AFTER the input!

Select Dropdowns

Dropdown Menus

```
<label for="major">Choose your major:</label>
<select id="major" name="major" required>
    <option value="">-- Select One --</option>
    <option value="journalism">Journalism</option>
    <option value="design">Design</option>
    <option value="marketing">Marketing</option>
    <option value="other">Other</option>
</select>
```

Key Points:

- First `<option>` with empty `value=""` = placeholder
- Each option needs a `value` (sent to server)
- Text shown to user can differ from `value`
- `required` prevents empty submission

Dropdowns save space when you have many options.

Textarea Element

Multi-line Text Input

```
<label for="bio">Tell us about yourself:</label>
<textarea id="bio"
          name="bio"
          rows="5"
          cols="50"
          maxlength="500"
          placeholder="Share your story..."></textarea>
```

Key Points:

- `rows` = Height (number of lines)
- `cols` = Width (number of characters)
- `maxlength` = Maximum characters
- Content goes between tags (not in `value`)

Note: Don't use `<input>` for long text!


Forms?
Tables?
Grouping Form Elements?
HAVE ANY
QUESTIONS?
Forms?
What's next?
The assignment?